

Notes on IPO Charts

Steps on how to do an IPO Chart:

1. Identify and write all the input variables in the INPUT column.
The input variables are found immediately after one of these keywords:
- Accept, get, enter, input.
2. Identify and write all the output variables in the OUTPUT column.
The output variables are found immediately after one of these keywords:
- Calculate, convert, display.
3. Write the processing steps in the PROCESSING column.

Steps on how to write instructions in the PROCESSING column:

1. Write simple English sentences to **accept** all the input variables.

Example:

Correct: 1. Accept the number of days.

Not fully correct: 1. Accept numDays *This is pseudocode not simple English.

2. Write simple English sentences to **calculate** the output variable(s).

Example:

Correct: 3. Calculate the total price.

Not fully correct: 3. totalPrice = 300 * numDays

****Note:** The output variable(s) can be calculated inside the IF Statements or before the IF Statements, so it depends on what the essay question requires.

2. Write simple English sentences of IF Statements.

Example:

Correct: If the code is DEV1, calculate the total fee.

Not fully correct: IF code = "DEV1" THEN totalFee = 500 * 12

3. Display the output variable(s).